

Vajra Beak: The Vow of the Nāgas

Vajratuṇḍa nāma nāgasamaya · Toh 759 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 759 in the Kangyur is a sūtra-related ritual or dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Vajratuṇḍa nāma nāgasamaya and in Tibetan as Dorje Chu zhes bya ba Klu'i damtsig, meaning "Vajra Beak: the Vow of the Nāgas." The text concerns the nāgas — the great serpent beings of Buddhist cosmology — and their relationship to vows and protective powers, set within a teaching the Buddha delivers in the city of Campā before a vast assembly of nāgas, gods, and humans. It belongs to the broad category of texts concerned with nāga rituals and protective observances, blending narrative framing with practical and ritual content aimed at the benefit of sentient beings. The text was translated into Tibetan by Chökyi Wangchuk Drakpa, and it is preserved as Toh 759 in the Kangyur, among the collections of dhāraṇī and related protective texts.

Translated by Chökyi Wangchuk Drakpa.

In the language of India: Vajratuṇḍa nāma nāgasamaya. In the Tibetan language: "Vajra Beak," the Vow of the Nāgas.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

Then the Blessed One was dwelling in the great city of Campā, in the midst of a vast assembly — a retinue of nāgas beginning with Jokpo and others, together with a great assembly of gods and humans — and for the great benefit of sentient beings he was teaching the Dharma that brings happiness by fulfilling all wishes and hopes completely.

From that same city there was a brahmin youth named Khyabma Chenma, who was wealthy and possessed of great riches, great resources, and an abundance of goods and provisions, who had gone to the far shore of the Vedas and their branches, who was learned in mantra, and who had accomplished mantra. Again and again he would summon nāgas and perform fire offerings. The harvest of that brahmin had been cut off by hail, and with the proud sound of his mantra recitation he declared: "By my power I shall bring a stream of rain and summon the nāgas." He then prepared to perform a fire offering, and he mixed sesame, rice, and mustard seed with hot butter and offered them into the fire.

Then, taking on the form of an unfriendly nāga, he enchanted an iron spike and drove it into the crown of that nāga's head. The nāga's skull split open and it became a great experience of pain and suffering. That nāga was greatly agitated and enraged, and in an instant and a moment it covered everything with the force of the nāga-pervading power, scattering scorching rays of burning light from its own body and covering all with great harm, burning the brahmin's fields to ash. Then it released a great torrent of hailstone rain upon the brahmin's body, and that brahmin, left without a protector, without refuge, without an ally, abandoned the fire offering and thought to flee and seek the Blessed One as his protector, refuge, and ally. He ran to where the Blessed One was, went to him, and touched his two feet, speaking these words:

"Blessed One, the wrathful nāgas are about to take my life and there is no refuge to be found. Blessed One, I implore you to protect me. Sugata, I implore you to protect me."

Then the Blessed One set that great brahmin at ease and declared: "Great brahmin, do not be afraid. I will be your protector, your refuge, and your ally." Having said this, he remained in silence.

Then Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas and lord of secrets, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, please look upon this. Even though a nāga is directly present, it disobeys and causes harm to the crops. Blessed One, when you have passed fully into nirvāṇa, in the final age and the final time, who will be the support of all sentient beings? What will become of them? Blessed One, please teach the means by which all crops are protected so they do not burn, by which they are guarded at all times and caused to increase greatly, by which crops are fully sustained and nāgas are repelled."

Then the Blessed One addressed Vajrapāṇi, the lord of secrets: "Vajrapāṇi, there is a dhāraṇī called 'Vajra, the Hidden Essence That Perfectly Tames Nāgas,' together with the tathāgatagarbha (buddha-nature) and mudrā, which was taught by the Tathāgatas, arhats, and perfectly complete buddhas of former times. I shall now teach it. By this, harm will quickly be averted and all crops will quickly be sustained and well protected."

Great ridges of fire mountains will cut off and contain all the nāgas from every quarter and direction on every side. Massive stacked clouds of blazing tongues of flame, called "The Force of Soaring Garuḍa Wings," will cover the sky in layer upon layer of cloud. All crops, flowers, and fruits will be guarded on every side and preserved. By this, all nāgas and the like will be utterly set ablaze.

Unruly nāgas will be destroyed and brought to submission.

Then Vajrapāṇi, the great yakṣa commander, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, for the benefit of all sentient beings, please explain the mantra words of this great dhāraṇī."

Thereupon the Blessed One declared this essence:

Namo bhagavate. Sarva buddhānāṃ. Namō bhagavate Śākyarājāya. Oṃ jvala jvala. Girāva bhani. Dīpta vega mahābhagavate mahācaṇḍa hṛdaya salanī. Huru huru. Hara hara. Daha daha. Paca paca. Sarva sasyā nāśaya. Nāga kulavaṃśa dhara dhara prasara caṇḍa vega mahābala parākrama spurita raudra vaktra. Matha matha. Prajvāla māla. Dhāraṇī. Caṇḍa vegavati. Bra para vimāndhāraṇī. Hūṃ hūṃ. Balavate. Vegavati. Sara sara. Visara visara saranti. Sarva sadrisya nanāmadrivana yadri. Puya phala phaṭ. Dra sandhāraṇī. Yā pas rventusarva nāgto ṇsarva bava bhavabhani. Vegata vegavati svāhā. Hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Nāgava sarāṇi phaṭ. Jvālamālinī phaṭ. Jālamālinī phaṭ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā.

The moment the Blessed One had spoken this vidyā that renders all nāgas and all unruly nāgas powerless, every nāga and great nāga was struck on the head, their bodies decayed, their forms became foul and malodorous, and they touched their heads to the two feet of the Blessed One and spoke these words:

"Blessed One, you have declared mantra words of exceeding and unbearable power. Blessed One, although we do not recall all the wrongs we have committed, yet when vidyā-holders who do us harm have treated us with contempt, beaten us, bound us, expelled us, and injured us, then, Blessed One, the unruly nāgas, stirred to agitation, have at those times caused crops, flowers, and fruits to fail, sent down hail, and stirred up frost and wind, caused rain to fall in torrential excess, or withheld all rain, or made rain fall out of season. Blessed One, we who hold the vidyā and recite the mantra shall dwell in loving-kindness. We shall put on the armor of loving-kindness. We shall hold the sword of loving-kindness in our hands, and by loving-kindness we shall pacify every act of harm.

"Blessed One, from this day forth we wish to make a pledge before the Tathāgata: wherever this queen of vidyās is actively employed, there, Blessed One, we shall not harm the nāgas. And wherever those who have been guarded, fully protected, firmly embraced, and well tended by this dhāraṇī of the essence, who have tied the cords, bound the boundaries, and drawn the maṇḍala boundaries — there, Blessed One, we vow to turn back continually

and without fail every form of harm. We shall guard on all sides all crops, flowers, and fruits, and tend them well. Even thieves, those who are treacherous, wild animals, and birds shall all be guarded on every side, and henceforth we shall cause no harm."

Then the Blessed One expressed approval to those lords of nāgas, saying: "Excellent! Excellent, lords of nāgas, excellent! Do as you have said. Guard and protect this Jambudvīpa well."

After that, at the conclusion of all the ritual acts performed in that ceremony, a declaration of auspiciousness is to be made. If harm is being done to the crops, then the holder of the vidyā should make a square maṇḍala in the middle of a field, on a rooftop, or in a high place, and set four filled vases at the four directions. Flowers scattered in fine array are to be placed there. Seven coiled effigies are to be made. Seven coils made of rice are also to be made, with twenty-one figures for each individual figure. A mixture of rice and milk-porridge, yoghurt, and fresh milk are to be placed there. Bells are to be placed at the four directions. A torma of cooked rice in the shape of a lotus, as before, is to be placed there. In the center of the maṇḍala a great vase is to be placed and filled with the five products of the cow, with milk, and with water. White mustard seeds and rice are to be poured in. The mantra is to be recited in full sixty times.

Four pegs of acacia wood and one iron peg are to be made, each measuring eight finger-widths in length. Four nāga images made either from yellow clay or from flour are to be made and placed at the four corners of the maṇḍala. Those acacia pegs are to be driven into the heart of each image. The mantra is to be recited in full one hundred and eight times. In the eastern direction, place a seven-headed nāga figure. In the western direction, one with eight heads. In the southern direction, one with five heads. In the northern direction, one with three heads. In the center of the maṇḍala, place one with nine heads. Five shallow bowls, one for each, are to be placed there. White mustard seeds and rice mixed together, with the mantra recited twenty-one times over them, are to be scattered in the four directions. This dhāraṇī is to be written down, attached to the top of a victory banner, and erected at the four corners of the maṇḍala. It is also to be erected in the center of the field, and also in the center of a garden grove.

The moment it is planted, the entire area will be bounded on all four sides by a great mountain ridge. For as long as the peg is not removed, there will be a

great enclosure of protection. All crops, all flowers, and all fruits will be thoroughly guarded. Not even a single leaf will wither — how much less will branches and trunks dry up. All species of living creatures, wild animals and birds alike, will be restrained and rendered incapable of causing harm. Wind, clouds, hail, frost, and unseasonable winds will also be unable to cause harm in that place. Even if nāgas attempt to do harm, they will be unable to cause any harm. And if any harm should have already occurred, it will be restored. The place will once again have strength, restoration, and radiance.

The contents of the great vase, when scattered in all four directions throughout the field, the pleasure grove, and the garden grove, will cause all living pests to disappear: snakes, rats, mongooses, mice, bears, frogs, mosquitoes, insects, rats, and winged creatures will all disappear. All ant colonies will disappear. Even cockroaches and the like will never appear again. Those born from warmth and moisture, those born by spontaneous generation, and those born from eggs will all be rendered incapable of causing harm. The forms of living creatures born from moisture and from flowers will never appear for as long as the peg has not been removed. For as long as the peg is not removed, the various kinds of nāga afflictions will not arise and will not occur at all. Happiness, good harvests, crops, flowers, and

all fruits will come to complete fulfillment. Tastes will become delicious and tender. All nāgas will continually and uninterruptedly protect, guard, and shelter the land. When the mantra is recited twenty-one times over powder and that powder is scattered over crops, flowers, leaves, and trees, all living creatures will fall away and disappear. Harmful insects — the traimabuka, the trailata, venomous snakes, eight-legged creatures, and other kinds of living beings — will all disappear and will not arise again for as long as the peg has not been removed.

For the pacification rite, it should be performed in the four directions of the field. If barley, wheat, sesame, white mustard, and rice are mixed with butter and a fire offering is performed, there will be great pacification. Even those who have been reborn in the destinies of animals will be rendered incapable of causing harm.

All the rites to be performed in connection with this dhāraṇī should be written down in full. The names of the Blessed One, the buddha; of the great sage Nyewar Dor; and of Vajrapāṇi should be written and affixed to the top of a victory banner and placed in a high position. Torma offerings, flowers, and

incense should also be presented.

When a khadira-wood peg eight finger-widths long is recited over one thousand times in full and then planted on top of a building, it will be capable of subduing all winds, frost, clouds, and hail. Living creatures that cause harm to crops, flowers, fruits, and leaves will all disappear — flesh flies, mosquitoes, the picilika, rats, bees, the traimabuka, the trailata, the viśakitaka, scaled fish, fish, the lomika, frogs, mongooses, pigs, the kantika, lions, the many-footed, the one-footed, tortoises, ants, honey bees, field bees, bumblebees, black ones, the śaṅganika, those that emerge from underground, the māluśika, owls, mice, long-snouted creatures, and all other such kinds of living beings — all will disappear, will not arise, and will all be destroyed. Crows, sparrows, the khugarta, pigeons, the madurika, owls, the khanajana, parrots, the rikegs, and all others like them will all disappear.

This mantra should be recited fully over the peg and the directions bound. Namō buddhāya. Oṃ kili mili caṇḍe, mere li caṇḍa caṇḍe bandhaya svāhā.

Then the great sage Nyewar Dor, who was seated not far at all from the Blessed One, upon hearing this dhāraṇī rose from his seat, touched his head to the two feet of the Blessed One, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I will bind, repel, and subdue all beings of whatever kind who intend harm, who intend severe harm, who carry poison, and who cause damage to crops, flowers, fruits, leaves, trunks, and roots. I will establish a great boundary extending for many leagues in all four directions. I will guard everywhere. Blessed One, in time to come, in future ages, I will repel all who intend harm and who intend severe harm. I will bestow the words of the mantra. Blessed One, for the benefit of all sentient beings and out of your compassion for me, please confer your blessing upon this."

The Blessed One then declared: "Great sage, I have conferred my blessing. For the benefit of all sentient beings and for the complete protection of crops, flowers, fruits, and gardens, speak the words of the dhāraṇī mantra."

Then the great sages, seated in the presence of the Blessed One, spoke thus: Namō bhagavate śākyarājāya.

tathāgatāya. Namō agastāya mahārṣaye. Tadyathā: kṣami culi, cala cara cara, homili, bandhani, nāśani, daha daha, sumari cari, sarvaduṣṭaṃ bandhani tuṇḍabandhani, sara saraṇi, kṣu kṣu kṣu, mani śuri bisara sara, hali huli, huti huti, saramaṇi, sarantu, sarvapāpānakṣudhali svāhā.

The moment the great sage Nyesador (Durvāsas) had spoken this vidyā mantra in the presence of the Blessed One, all those nāgas, yakṣas, and rākṣasas who had intended harm prostrated themselves face down upon the ground and, with loud, piercing cries, wailed before the Blessed One: "Blessed One, we have been at fault. The curse of the sage has fallen upon us. Blessed One, we are burned by the fire of the sage's curse. We are utterly scorched. Blessed One, Śākyamuni, from this day forward we shall no longer harm any sentient being in Jambudvīpa. Blessed One, from this day forward we shall no longer do harm to crops, flowers, fruits, or leaves. We shall repel every species of harmful creature."

The Blessed One then declared to them: "Lords of the nāgas, do as you have said. Guard and protect with care all crops, flowers, fruits, leaves, and branches, so that they may flourish abundantly for all sentient beings of Jambudvīpa."

Then the great sage spoke the ritual procedure, saying: "Blessed One, face toward the east, approach, and I shall recite this heart-essence of the great sage's vidyā one hundred and eight times over mustard seeds soaked in water, and, with the silent recitation of the sage, scatter them in the four directions."

Avasara sara, śapata padāma, hṛdaya krodha, amuka bandhaya, praṇa cara, sumuru cala svāhā.

"I shall recite this mantra seven thousand times. By that recitation alone, all nāgas who intend harm shall be tormented by heat. Every species of creature, whether two-footed or four-footed, shall be afflicted by the curse and all shall flee. Thereafter they shall no longer do harm to crops in that region. Every species of harmful creature shall be absent. Every species of harmful creature shall be absent henceforth as well. And no longer shall crops, flowers, fruits, or leaves be harmed."

The Blessed One then said "Excellent!" to the great sage: "Excellent! Excellent! Do so in such a way that you will thoroughly protect all sentient beings, and thoroughly protect all crops, flowers, and fruits."

Then Vajrapāṇi, the great commander of the yakṣas, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "In time to come, in future ages, I shall guard and fully protect them. Blessed One, please confer your blessing upon this."

"Vajrapāṇi, Excellent! Excellent! Thoroughly protect all sentient beings."

Here ends the chapter on nāgas that do harm to crops.

Then, after this, the Blessed One, dwelling for a long while, displaying great majesty, attended by a great assembly and great retinue, endowed with great power by reason of his qualities, and manifesting great miraculous displays, proceeded to the residence of the great king Vaiśravaṇa.

As the Blessed One drew near to the residence of Vaiśravaṇa, in that locality there was a forest known as "the forest of twenty herders," and in the clearing of that forest there was a small pond. By the power of that pond, the willow palace with its surrounding fields, pleasure groves, forests, leaves, flowers, and fruits was all abundantly satisfied. Men and women, boys and girls,

cattle, horses, mares, buffalo, elephants, donkeys, and all the crowds of people were abundantly satisfied with comfort. That small pond measured two yojanas in extent in all four directions. The pond was entirely covered with various flowers — blue lotuses (utpala), red lotuses (padma), white day-blooming lotuses (kumuda), and white night-blooming lotuses (puṇḍarīka) — and it was filled with various kinds of fish, water-sprites, makara-fish, child-devouring crocodiles, and bees of many forms.

Then, as a drought came upon that place, all the forests, flowers, fruits, leaves, and branches withered and dried, and the flowers faded. The fish, crocodiles, makara-fish, child-devouring crocodiles, and bees of many forms scattered as the water receded, and with only a little remaining, they darted and fled in all ten directions, rushing and scattering, until they were overcome by the cessation of breath and the cutting off of life, their hearts pounding as they fled.

Then the Blessed One came, with his great retinue, to that pond, and there he saw fish, crocodiles, child-devouring crocodiles, and many hundreds of thousands of bees overcome by the cessation of breath and the cutting off of life, fleeing in all ten directions. Regarding them with the eye of compassion, the Blessed One, with a breath suffused with the intention of loving-kindness, called out to the nāgas with the sound of his finger-snap, snapping his fingers two and three times, and caused that sound to resound throughout the great trichiliocosm. By reason of certain karmic conditions from the past, those living creatures did not die. But those great nāgas neither heard that sound nor recalled the Blessed One.

Then a yakṣa of the māra class, named Scattered Wind, proclaimed throughout the great trichiliocosm that, within seven days, a conflagration

aeon would arise — that from the summit of existence down to the hell of Avīci, there would not be the slightest thing left unburned. The proclamation rang out: "A great terror has arisen in the world." Then all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great serpents (mahoragas), humans, and non-humans, upon hearing that proclamation, wept and cried aloud: "The world has become a place of ruin!"

Then the Blessed One, though knowing that this was something to be experienced through the conditions of karma, nonetheless turned his mind to it, and a ray of light issued from the ūrṇā-hair between the brows of the Blessed One. That ray of light illuminated all the dwellings of the nāgas and then turned back, dissolving into the crown of his head.

Then the nāga king called Encircled by the Aspect of an Umbrella gathered all the nāgas and spoke these words: "O nāgas and great nāgas, why has this ray of light arisen, and by what condition has it appeared in the world?" Then the great nāga king Ocean reflected and saw that the ray of light had arisen by the power of the Blessed One. Then the nāga king Ocean, together with other nāga kings of great power, went to where the Blessed One was, approached him, and touched his feet, and spoke thus: "Blessed One, what is the cause and condition by which you released that ray of light, illuminated all the dwellings, and caused it to turn back?"

The Blessed One declared: "O lords of the nāgas, many hundreds of thousands of living creatures are on the verge of being cut off by the cessation of breath."

Then, in that very instant — in that very moment and flash of time — the nāga king Ocean filled the pond with a continuous flow of rain-water and caused all to be satisfied with comfort.

Then a great open space appeared in that area, and the Blessed One took his seat there in the midst of a great retinue, surrounded on all sides and arrayed before him. The great assembly of nāgas that had gathered was as follows: eighty thousand nāga kings — the nāga king Ocean and all the other nāga kings — surrounded by a canopy of parasols. They rose from their seats, went to where the Blessed One was, touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, paid homage, and circumambulated him three times. Then they made offerings to the Blessed One with flowers, incense, garlands, perfume, unguents, ornaments, streamers, and various garments, and sat down in the presence of the Blessed One.

Then the four great kings, facing the Blessed One, bowed with palms pressed together and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, a tremendous and unbearable terror has arisen in the world — namely, drought has come and the land has fallen into famine. Blessed One, through this suffering all sentient beings have been left without a protector, without refuge, without allies. We therefore entreat the Blessed One to speak the words of a mantra in accordance with this situation — one by which, in future times and future ages, beings throughout the world falling into various sufferings may be liberated; one that will prevent excessive rain and the absence of rain, untimely rain, hail, frost, and extreme cold; that will put an end to famine and desolation; and that will avert all such harms and protect beings. We entreat the Blessed One to speak the words of a dhāraṇī mantra for this purpose."

Then the Blessed One addressed the four great kings — the great king Vaiśravaṇa (the divine guardian of the north), the great king Dhṛtarāṣṭra (the guardian of the east), the great king Virūḍhaka (the guardian of the south), and the great king Virūpākṣa (the guardian of the west) — with these words: "O great kings, there is a dhāraṇī mantra-phrase that urges the essence-heart of the nāgas to blaze, called All-Blazing Lightning. By merely calling it to mind, the dwellings of all nāgas and the bodies of all nāgas will burst into flame. The hearts of all insubordinate nāgas will pound with terror. The heads of all nāgas will split open into seven pieces. Their eyes and heads will crack apart and be cut to pieces and scattered. O great kings, take up this dhāraṇī for the sake of the nāgas who intend harm and who intend great harm, and for the sake of all sentient beings."

Then the four great kings touched their heads to both feet of the Blessed One and addressed him thus: "Blessed One, we entreat you to speak the dhāraṇī mantra-phrase of the essence-heart of the nāgas, called All-Blazing Lightning."

Then the Blessed One, gazing with the gaze of a nāga and the gaze of a Tathāgata, looked upon the entire assembled gathering of nāgas and spoke to them thus: "O lords of nāgas, hear from me the words of the dhāraṇī mantra-phrase:

Tadyathā: oṃ pibule pravare nāge mahānāgahṛdaya āvarte jvala jvala sarvanāgahṛdayāni kimi kimi nāgakulavidhvaṃsdhani hana hana sarvanāgaduṣṭāṃhṛdayāni hana hana sarvaduṣṭāṃnāgabhavanāni paca paca pacaya sarvaduṣṭāṃnāgānāṃ akṛma akṛma samudrasāgara vimale vikrame mahānāgagate japare svāhā."

The moment the Blessed One had spoken these words of the essence dhāraṇī mantra, all those nāgas trembled, their bodies decayed, and they became malodorous. Smoke billowed and curled from their bodies as though they were on fire, and they turned back and fled.

All of them cried out loudly to the Blessed One, and all of them together addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, you have spoken to us mantra-phrases that are utterly unbearable. Blessed One, our hearts will all be shaken. Blessed One, we have all been scorched and made wretched. Blessed One, from this day forward we shall act in harmony. Before the eyes of the Blessed One we shall take a solemn oath. Blessed One, for as long as we dwell in the birthplaces of nāgas, we shall not harm the beings of Jambudvīpa, and we shall not act wickedly toward them. We shall cause all flowers, branches, fruits, and crops to flourish abundantly. Season by season we shall send down streams of rain. We shall bring happiness and ease of mind. We shall cause all crops, flowers, and fruits to come to fruition. We shall uphold the word of the Tathāgata. We shall abide by our truthful pledge. We shall protect all sentient beings as though each were our only child. Blessed One, in whatever direction and place this queen of vidyā-mantras is practiced, there we shall act in accord with it. Blessed One, by the mere recollection of this king of vidyā-mantras, we shall cause streams of rain to fall for all of us. By mere recollection we shall also avert excessive rainfall. We shall not deviate from what the Blessed One has declared."

The Blessed One then again uttered the words of the oath-bound mantra. And then all those nāga kings touched their heads to the two feet of the Blessed One and spoke thus:

Tadyathā: om̐ cata cata vicata, śata śata, pacāraṭi svāhā.

"Blessed One, if the holder of the vidyā-mantra should spread out an umbrella for even a single day and we were to fail to send down streams of rain throughout all of Jambudvīpa for the welfare of all sentient beings, then, Blessed One, we would be found guilty before the perfectly and fully awakened buddha. And it may even come about that we die and pass from our nāga birthplaces. Blessed One, at that time the holder of the vidyā-mantra shall recite these words of the oath-bound dhāraṇī-mantra seven times from the very beginning. After that, one hundred and eight seeds of rebirth shall be cast upon the nāga seeds as hailstones. Blessed One, at that time all our dwellings that have been entered and set ablaze — until we are utterly freed, with only

the remains of bare bones left — shall be cut apart piece by piece. At that time we shall quickly bring down streams of rain for all of them. If rain does not quickly pour down, Blessed One, then at that time all of us shall fall under the power of death and perish — perishing together with our sons and grandsons."

Then the four great kings headed by Vaiśravaṇa addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, the nāgas have spoken mantra-phrases that are utterly unbearable. They have spoken oath-bound pledges without compassion."

The Blessed One declared: "Great kings, in a future time yet to come, there will arise nāgas that are disobedient, wicked, fierce, and harmful. At that time, through fear and dread of this oath, they shall duly send down streams of rain in their proper seasons, and season by season they shall bring forth crops, flowers, and fruits."

Then the great king Vaiśravaṇa addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, please be so kind as to explain the ritual in full."

Then the Blessed One set forth the ritual, saying: at a time when rain is not falling, one should go to a mountain, or a forest retreat, or a temple, or

a spring, a pond, a lake, a marsh, a well, or a small lake that is a dwelling of nāgas. There one should make a triangular maṇḍala of clay mixed with mud. At the center of the maṇḍala one should dig a hollow a cubit deep, and its rim should also rise a cubit high. It should be made very smooth and very clean. Scented water is to be sprinkled all around it. In the center of the maṇḍala one should place four great nāga kings: made from yellow clay mixed with mud, each a nine-headed nāga king with his body coiled nine times, and on every head a wish-fulfilling jewel is to be placed. In the east, place the nāga king Ocean. In the south, place the nāga king Canopy. In the west, place the nāga king Water God. In the north, place the nāga king Lambukāra. Each of these is to be attended by a retinue of seven, some three-headed, some two-headed, some five-headed. Their bodies are to be anointed with various perfumes. White and red sandalwood, surāviṇacana, juniper, and saffron are to be ground into powder and scattered. Garlands of flowers are to be hung. In the center of the site, rice and white mustard seeds are to be scattered. At the four corners, the four great kings are to be placed. In the four great directions, images of the buddha Śākyamuni with relics, and reliquary stūpas with relics, are to be set up. These are to be adorned with silks and banners. Offerings of the five kinds are to be made. Aloe wood, sandalwood, and resin are to be

burned as incense. Bdellium, nāla, kunduru, white mustard, gandhara, heartwood resin, and white resin are to be mixed with honey, the mantra recited twenty-one times, and the incense offered to the nāgas. At every edge of the maṇḍala, lotuses made of rice flour are to be drawn. At each of the four praised gateways, on each of the four sides, seven bowls filled with torma offerings are to be placed. White torma and many different flavors of food as available are to be set out. Scattered offerings of various flowers are to be made. Four filled vases are to be placed. Four vases filled with torma are to be placed. In four incense bowls, gugul incense is to be burned. Lamps with eight wicks are to be lit. The mantra-holder is to perform a fire offering at the eastern gate, casting juniper wood, white mustard, and red sesame mixed together one hundred and eight times into the fire. When the one hundred and eight castings are complete, all the nāgas shall send down streams of rain, and streams of rain shall descend from all four directions throughout all of Jambudvīpa. All those nāgas shall cause rain to fall here. This is the first ritual.

White mustard butter, honey, and flowers of the kāravīra tree, together with nāgakeśara, are to be made into bound pills. Then the mantra is to be recited over each pill one hundred and eight times, and the pills thrown into the nāga lake. Immediately upon casting them, all the nāgas will become joyful and will send down great streams of rain. If rain does not fall at that very moment, all those nāgas will suffer the breaking apart of their bodies, will suffer headache, and will experience great suffering. This is the second ritual.

Ash from the fire offering is to be mixed with coarse sand. After the mantra is recited sixty times, a messenger, male or female, is immediately to scatter it inside houses. Upon this, all the nāgas will be agitated, and on account of this agitation they will send down streams of rain. If rain does not fall at that very moment, the bodies of all those nāgas will break out in blotches, they will be afflicted with leprosy, and they will go blind. This is the third ritual.

Juniper, blue lotus, wool, copper filings, white mustard, indrahasta, and palāśa are to be mixed together, kneaded with sugar-cane juice, and with the mantra of a person of wisdom recited eighty times, formed into pills the size of a juniper seed. At a time when rain is not falling, if seven such pills are thrown into the dwelling of the nāgas, rain will fall for seven days and seven nights. If rain does not fall immediately thereafter, on that account all the water in the dwellings of those nāgas will dry up entirely.

All those dwelling in the nāga's realm will become naked. One of the pills is to be attached to the tip of a victory banner and cast into the lake of the nāgas. A blue pennant is to be hung there. If this mantra is written out and affixed in that place, then for as long as the victory banner has not been taken down, all the nāgas will send rain. Again, one is to be attached to the tip of a victory banner and placed high upon a rooftop. When the time comes for hail to fall, the nāgas will be unable to bring down hail. The nāgas will behold the thing as though it were the color of gold, and all the nāgas, filled with awe and dread, will send rain in that place according to one's wish.

The mantra is: Om suprate vajra dunde mili mili svāhā.

A nine-headed nāga figure is to be fashioned from flour, and its body anointed with vermilion. A pennant is to be hung at its neck. A square maṇḍala is to be made, the nāga figure placed at its center, and small flowers scattered about it. White torma cakes are to be offered in as great a quantity as one can provide. Flowers and incense are likewise to be offered.

With a branch of a Nepalese peach tree, the mantra is to be recited fully one hundred and eight times per repetition. Then, using the mantra and the branch of the Nepalese peach tree, one is to strike the nāga figure one hundred and eight times. Whichever nāga's name has been written, that nāga will be summoned, and that nāga will no longer be pleased with its own dwelling. If it does not send a good flow of rain without delay, it will at once become unable to sustain its life.

For each seed of white mustard, the mantra is to be recited fully one thousand and eight times. When all one thousand and eight are complete, all the forms of the nāgas will move about and toss their heads. If thereafter one strikes them with the branch of the Nepalese peach tree, they will rise up and display their tongues. They will display them all along the length of their bodies. All the nāgas will come under one's power and will do exactly as they are commanded.

With milk and white mustard, the mantra is to be recited fully one hundred and eight times, and if it is scattered in every direction, in every place the results will be turned to good. This is the fourth ritual.

Then the nāga king of the ocean and other greatly powerful nāga kings — a hundred thousand nāga kings — rose from their seats, touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, you have declared mantra words of utterly unbearable power. You have declared deeds

of accomplishment utterly unbearable in their force. Blessed One, we too will speak in the same manner. At the proper times we will send a flow of rain. Henceforth we will not bring harm to sentient beings. Blessed One, if we wish to teach the words of a mantra of nāga vows that will turn back those nāgas who are unruly and do harm, and those who have broken their pledges, we beseech the Blessed One to bestow his blessing. O Virtuous Master of Nāgas, by the blessing of the pledge-mantra, let it be spoken."

Namo bhagavate Śākyamunaye tathāgatāya. Tadyathā: bhuḍze bhuḍze samaya bhuḍze tattva bhuḍze prabhara bhuḍze samanta ākāra bhuḍze duru duru svāhā. Samaya balane svāhā. Nāga marasañcodani svāhā.

"Blessed One, in future times, in future ages, in order to turn back all unruly nāgas, we have thus spoken this mantra of the nāga vow. When there is excessive rain, or when rain is scarce, or when frost or hail falls, this mantra is to be called to mind and recited aloud. Thereafter all the nāgas are to be urged on.

The vidyādhara — the holder of the mantra — is to bathe very thoroughly and make himself pure. Having dressed in fresh garments, he is to go to the dwelling place of the nāgas. At the nāga's abode, a maṇḍala of incense is to be made with whatever is available, and an image of the Blessed One Śākyamuni, or a stūpa containing his relics, is to be placed upon that maṇḍala and bathed with fragrant water. It is to be worshipped with flowers and incense. All the nāgas are likewise to be bathed."

The water used for the bathing of the image is to be recited over with the mantra eight times, and white mustard seed is then to be placed in it. It is to be poured into that lake, and incense burned from all four directions. The moment this is done, the nāga's dwelling will tremble, and something resembling smoke will arise. This will transform into a great canopy of clouds, and from that cloud-canopy covering the sky, a continuous stream of rain will fall.

When hail is falling, white mustard seed mixed with sesame is to be recited over twenty-one times and then cast in the four directions. It is to be thrown to the ground in the direction of the nāgas. The hail will cease to fall, and all the nāgas will be restrained. Frost, hail, and unseasonable winds will all be completely pacified.

By the shore of a nāga's lake, well, marsh, or pond, or on the peak of a mountain, if one performs a fire offering of one thousand and eight oblations

using the arka plant, clarified butter, white mustard seed, and the flowers of the kārṇvīra plant, all will be accomplished. Immediately upon completing the fire offering, a great continuous rainfall will descend.

When the rain is excessively heavy, one is to recite the mantra over rice grains and white mustard seed one hundred and eight times and scatter them into the sky. The heavy rain will be averted.

Then the nāgas themselves spoke, saying: "O Blessed One, if we fail to bring down a stream of rain within three months, then at that time, O Blessed One, mottled patches will appear on our bodies, our bodies will become foul-smelling, and we will be deceiving the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. We will be deceiving the three worlds. May we then be reborn in the realm of the nāgas."

The Blessed One then said: "When applied to all other cases as well, all will be effective."

This concludes the section on the pledge of the nāgas and the bringing of rain, known as "The Pledge of the Nāgas."

Thereupon the Blessed One was dwelling in the Brahmā Palace, and many assemblies of gods arrived, along with a great retinue of bodhisattvas. Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, also arrived, as did Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Great God (Śiva), and all the mighty nāga lords. The lord of the sky-soaring ones arrived, and likewise the great king with golden-winged eyes and a vajra beak — a great being whose body blazes with terrifying and awe-inspiring wrathful power — wearing a crown adorned with various precious jewels, pearls, and gold upon his head, his form sheathed in gold, majestic in bearing, using a nāga lord as his seat, attended by his many retinues. The lord of the yakṣas, Vajrapāṇi, arrived together with ten million yakṣas (Skt. yakṣa), and one thousand vidyādhara in the retinue of Vajrapāṇi also arrived.

The Blessed One was seated upon a lion throne adorned with many varied precious jewels and decorated with numerous different red pearls, dwelling in the tiered palace, endowed with the great blessing of the Tathāgata, surrounded by that great blessing's pervading presence. The Blessed One's body was supremely adorned by countless hundreds of thousands of millions of rays of multicolored light. Like a golden offering-tree, his body blazed; like the sun, it shone. His form was beautifully adorned with a cubit's breadth of light, and he was endowed with the thirty-two major marks and the eighty excellent minor marks. The light of the Tathāgata's body was supremely pure,

supremely radiant, utterly free from blemish and stain.

Then, knowing that the great assembly had gathered, the Blessed One emitted from his body rays of multicolored light, and with the radiance of those rays he caused the ten directions to be pervaded entirely. Thereupon Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and

the Great God (Śiva), having gazed upon the rays of light of the Tathāgata, saw that in Jambudvīpa the nāgas were not being restrained, and so they sent down hail, wind, yellow clouds, and scorched all the flowers, all the fruits, all the crops, the trees, the grasses, the vines, the medicines, and the forests, burning everything between them, rendering it all barren, so that not a single branch remained in Jambudvīpa — all was made desolate. Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and the Great God heard the cry of those sentient beings, tormented and utterly overcome by tremendous suffering.

Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and the Great God touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One and spoke these words: "Blessed One, the wrathful nāgas who intend harm have devastated Jambudvīpa, rendering all of it barren, and sentient beings are experiencing immeasurable and unbearable suffering."

The Blessed One declared: "O lords of gods, this is something to be witnessed directly. Look upon the blessing of the Tathāgata, the profound wisdom of the buddhas, and the distinctive blessing of the Tathāgata's qualities."

Then the Blessed One, casting his gaze on high like a garuḍa soaring through the sky, and looking in every direction, entered into the meditative absorption called Surveying All Directions Like a Garuḍa Soaring Through the Sky — the absorption of magical display, wreathed in blazing flames on all sides. The moment he entered that absorption, both his shoulders blazed brilliantly, and the moment they blazed, the bodies of all the nāgas burst into flame.

Then the great nāga kings, surrounded by their canopies, touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One and spoke these words: "Blessed One, enough! Sugata, enough!"

Then the Blessed One, without speaking a word, gazed upward and looked in all ten directions, paid homage to all the Tathāgatas, and with the great force of the garuḍa soaring blazing through all directions, he contemplated this maṇḍala, the essence-heart of the garuḍa's splendor:

Oṃ vajra-vatigaruḍa-vege hūṃ hūṃ. Ra ci śrī ja hūṃ phaṭ.

Thereupon those unruly nāgas became slack and limp, and sat trembling in the presence of the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One proclaimed the great heart-essence called the Tathāgata's Blazing Garuḍa Flame:

Namo bhagavate. Śākyamunaye. Tathāgatāya. Oṃ vajra jvala jvala prajvala. Hana hana. Sarva nāga hṛdaya dhāraṇī. Hara hara. Sarva kananāṃ bala-vīrya-parākramam. Daha daha. Sarva nāga śarīrāṇi. Paca paca. Sarva nāga māraṇī. Garuḍa-vega pakṣiṇī-pate. Natpataya pataya. Sarva nāga bhuvanāni. Oṃ mata mata. Mahā-vicitra-maṇi mohu li dara hamahā-rudra-vega dara vicitra. Āvaraṇa-vibhu huśīta-kāya. Sarva nāgūnāṃ. Kara kara. Smara smara. Bho garuḍena varam thagam bantranaśākyamune pracanam anupālaya. Tarjaya. Nāgānī. Pakṣāya. Duṣṭam pramadāya. Vāyu-veja gapam. Spoṭaya. Mūrtānāna śoṣaya. Vidujvalan. Hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ. Pramata sarvabata aśinna mekam. Nāśaya nāśaya. Sarva nāga balaṃ pahara. Pracatunten. Āgar pāya. Suśānāgana. Garja garja. Mahā-garuḍa-pegan. Hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ. Stambhaya niśīta palahakam. Sambhakṣaya. Hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ. Stambhaya. Śīta vāyu. Mughan. Sarva nāgābhihaṇiṇī. Hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ. Bho nāgādhipati. Muñca hrīḥ. Bhaṣa bhu yuṃ garuḍa-krodha-mahā-vega-bandha. Vāyu-balahakanti ti. Ṭi ṭi ṭi.

Hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ. Bhaṣaya. Vataśīta āśanāni. Nāśaya. Citi citi. Phaṭ phaṭ. Svāhā. Āśāya. Nāgānāna bandhaya. Vajribhinena tathāgata samantena. Satyena. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā. Ti ti ti ti. Hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ svāhā. Jalambaduḥ. Sarva aśānta tathāgata adhiṣṭhānena hūṃ phaṭ. Amṛte mabhavatu sarva śīta pāyu vega āśani. Hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ. Mātikrama sphoṭaya. Nāga matikrama māte mūrtanam. Yatiśīti. Huru huru. Hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ svāhā. Partāya svāhā. Nāga sphoṭaya svāhā. Nāga vidārāya svāhā. Oṃ svāhā. Svā svū hā. Bhuva svāhā. Tathāgata samaya svāhā. Trailokya pūjitāya svāhā. Oṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ.

O Lords of nāgas, this great dhāraṇī called the Essence of the Blazing Garuḍa of the Tathāgata wards off all nāgas that are inimical. It destroys all clouds, hailstorms, wind, and hail. It repels them. It fully protects the harvest. It fully protects flowers, fruits, and forests. It brings the fruit of nectar to complete fulfilment. It causes that which is sown thereby to increase and flourish.

O Lords of nāgas, by the mere recollection of this, those who perform the rites of the nāga maṇḍala — together with their sons and wives, together with their ministers, together with those dispatched as envoys, together with their

retinues — those who generate the power of storms, who generate the power of wind, who gather and exert force: let all of them, through the command of the Tathāgata and through the blessing of the Tathāgata's sacred pledge, in future times and future ages, protect throughout this Jambudvīpa all harvests, all flowers and fruits, all substances, trees, and medicines. Let the rains fall in their season in a steady stream. Just as my own life is sustained, so too let all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa be nourished. Protect flowers, fruits, and harvests thoroughly.

But if it should happen otherwise — if they do not act in accordance with the virtuous command of the Tathāgata — then at that time may the dwellings of all the nāgas blaze, blaze fiercely, and blaze everywhere, and may they burn in a single mass of flame. May great famine come upon the nāgas. May their strength wane and their diligence become utterly futile. May their waters dry up. May their abodes dry out. May their bodies grow rough. May they be seized by terror of Garuḍa with his fine wings, by terror of fire and sand, and by terror of constant hunger and thirst. May they run to and fro, their bodies scorched everywhere, thoroughly tormented by the heat of the sun, their bodies burned. May diseases, harms, and manifold contagions gather upon them.

Thus, in future times and ages, if those nāgas who are inimical, those nāgas who are fierce, those who are utterly fierce, should transgress and act contrary to this dhāraṇī called the Essence of the Blazing Garuḍa of the Tathāgata, they shall experience such suffering as this. Therefore, O Lords of nāgas, by the sworn oath of truth, you must follow and uphold the sacred pledge of the Tathāgata. You must fully protect, guard, and accomplish benefit for all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa.

Then the Nāga King, surrounded on all sides in the form of a canopy, along with the great Nāga King Ocean, the great Nāga King Nandaka, the great Nāga King Upanandaka, the great Nāga King Maṇin, the great Nāga King Hulava, the great Nāga King Varuṇa, the great Nāga King known as the Crest of the All-Blazing and Supremely Joyous Opener, and the great Nāga King Brahmaśīras —

the great Nāga King Renowned as Victory Banner in the Three Worlds, the great Nāga King Splendor of the Sovereign, the great Nāga King known as Widely Renowned Light, the great Nāga King known as the Form of the Victory Banner on All Sides, the great Nāga King Jewel Head, the great Nāga King Supremely Abiding Brahmā's Crest, the great Nāga King Blazing Crest Jewel,

the great Nāga King Crusher of the Great Ocean, the great Nāga King Eye That Sees All, the great Nāga King Viṣṇu's Encirclement, the great Nāga King Completely Liberated on All Sides, the great Nāga King Rain-Sender of Supreme Joy, the great Nāga King Purely Supreme Rejoicing, the great Nāga King Supreme Disperser, the Nāga King Blazing Lightning, the great Nāga King Son of the Earth Guardian, the great Nāga King Sender of Various Rains, the great Nāga King Power of Releasing and Holding, the great Nāga King Who Sends Rain Throughout the Three Worlds, and the great Nāga King Many Sons of Vaiśravaṇa — these and the other great nāga kings, eighty-four thousand in number, each attended by a retinue of seventy-seven thousand nāga clans, went to where the Blessed One was. They circumambulated the Blessed One three times, made great offerings, touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"O Blessed One, because you have proclaimed these mantra words of extreme severity, great ferocity, and great difficulty to behold, we are overwhelmed. We are struck speechless. Our bodies tremble violently. Our hair stands on end. O Blessed One, we confess that we have been present here, openly and in person before the Blessed One, and that with such terror our very pores bristle, and that an unbearable, overwhelming fear has arisen in us, and that we remain here, confused and dismayed even in our very confession. O Blessed One, in the final age, the last time, after the Tathāgata has passed into nirvāṇa, when fierce and violent monks who are greedy for wealth shall make petitions to avert frost, wind, hail, and such things — O Blessed One, how shall those nāgas who are unwilling to comply be diligent in this? How shall their lives be restored and what will become of them? O Blessed One, how shall our sons and grandsons become numerous?"

Then the Blessed One spoke to those great lords of nāgas, saying: "O lords of nāgas, in the future, in the last age, you must abide in loving-kindness. You must act in accord with the sacred pledge of the Tathāgata. Send streams of rain at the proper times. At the proper times cause flowers, fruits, and crops to grow. Turn back all frost, wind, cloud, and hail. Do not cause destruction. Therefore, O lords of nāgas, in the future, in the last age, dwell so as to cause no harm. O lords of nāgas, if you do not truly uphold the sacred pledge, because of that a great offense will fall upon you." This was declared.

Here is concluded the vidyā of the initial invitation of the nāgas.

Then, following that, the ritual of the root vidyā that pacifies the wrath of the nāgas — the heart essence maṇḍala of the Blazing Splendor of Garuḍa — is to be recited. At the very outset, gazing upward into the sky, one scatters white mustard seeds mixed with water in the four directions, and all frost, wind, cloud, and hail will be subdued and bound.

All the nāgas will tremble violently and be laid low. One recites the mantra twenty-one times over ash mixed with water, and upon empowering it, one will have accomplished self-protection.

When thunder is heard, one fully recites the mantra twenty-seven times over white mustard seeds, and recites it seven times over water, and thereby binds the clouds in the sky. Then, gazing at the clouds, one scatters the white mustard seeds upward into the sky, and all flowers and fruits are gathered together and fall to the ground. While reciting the mantra, one utters the syllable PHAṬ with wrathful force, and by uttering PHAṬ three times, the young nāgas too will fall, and the bodies of the nāgas will dissolve and collapse upon the plain.

One fully recites the mantra twenty-one times over a wool or silk cord, and then winds it seven times in the manner of a wheel, whereupon all malevolent nāgas are struck down, and frost, wind, and hail of every kind do not descend upon the earth. Their heads split open in seven places, and their eyes burst out. When the mantra is recited one hundred and eight times with wrathful force, all the nāgas together with their clans, their clouds, and their entire retinues of attendants fall upon the ground. All the dwellings of the nāgas and their celestial palaces without exception, together with their waters, their trees, and their forests, become a single mass of blazing fire. All the great nāga kings, however magnificent and however powerful, are struck by a fierce ailment of the head. If the vidyā-holder does not quickly come to their aid, all their clans will be destroyed. Their sons, grandsons, retinues, and mounts will be made to vanish utterly, left without eyes.

In times when there is no rain, one recites the mantra one thousand times over white mustard seeds and scatters them upon a dwelling-place. All the nāgas tremble violently, and the dwelling and the lake become a single mass of blazing fire, and as swiftly as one desires, a continuous flow of rain descends. Again and again the continuous flow of rain descends.

When rain is needed, the vidyā-holder recites the mantra one hundred and eight times fully over water and white mustard seeds, proceeds to a high

place, sits facing east, and recites the mantra seven times each over seven handfuls of water, casting them toward the east. All the nāga kings gather together at once in that very instant and send down a continuous flow of rain.

At the time of dawn, one mixes white mustard seeds and saffron with water and recites the mantra seven times, then scatters the mixture in the four directions and also upward and downward. Thereby all frost, wind, cloud, and hail are confined and cut off on every side within the extent of a league. All malevolent nāgas will be bound. All the nāgas will be unable to pass through.

One gathers up the dung of a dun-gray donkey before it falls to the ground, along with the butter and milk and urine of that same animal, and mixes them with salt, children's flour porridge, and grain flour. One recites the mantra ninety-two times. Then one fashions a five-headed nāga effigy. One forms it sitting cross-legged with its hoods raised and its body coiled. One washes the body with white sandalwood and saffron. It is placed upon a clean seat. It is empowered with a silk crown. A garland of flowers is fastened upon it. One makes a square maṇḍala, scatters loose flowers, and places four filled vases. Four arrows are inserted, and four white silk pennants are fastened to them. An offering cake is placed in the center of the maṇḍala. Four thorns of sengdeng acacia are inserted at the four corners of the maṇḍala. The whole is encircled five times with a five-colored thread. Over everything one recites the mantra twenty-one times and performs the ritual. The vases are bound about the neck with silk. Nut-grass, hard resin of sal tree, Chinese incense, costus root, nail clippings, nāga flower, white mustard seeds, and —

— sugar are mixed together; one recites the mantra one hundred and eight times and performs fumigation with it. That fumigation is prepared and applied.

Then the vidyādhara bathes most thoroughly, dons clean robes, and by means of this very mantra performs the following: touching the body, binding cliffs, binding boundaries, binding directions, binding the maṇḍala, spreading robes, self-protection, and bathing.

The nāga image is set down with its face turned toward the east. The vidyādhara gazes at the nāga, sits cross-legged, and by means of this very mantra performs the invoking, the offering-cake offering, and the fumigation, then sends it forth again.

Then the vidyādhara recites one thousand and eight times, and for each individual white mustard seed, recites over it and pricks it into the body of the

nāga image. Four lamps are lit. The name of the nāga is written. Whoever calls upon it will be gratified.

When the full one thousand and eight recitations have been completed, the great nāga king will come under one's power. He will reveal all things. Whatever is wished for, all of it will be granted. All forms of power will be reversed. One's own people, together with one's retinue, and all of one's sons and grandsons will come under one's power. All activities will be accomplished. He will nurture and care for one as one's own household. The nāga image is to be placed in a secluded spot, and flowers and incense are to be offered to it. It must be kept concealed, not seen, and not shown to anyone. It is covered with clean cloth. Whenever there is need, one recites over a white mustard seed one hundred and eight times and pricks it — and all needs will be fulfilled. It will go wherever it is dispatched and return again. In dreams it will reveal all needs and perform all activities. This is called "Sending the nāga on a mission."

Whenever clouds, wind, hail, or frost arise out of season, one mixes the grain of life-seeds together with white mustard seeds and recites one hundred and one times; then, in a state of wrath, one pricks the nāga image — and in that very instant the wind, hail, and clouds will cease and all will be bound.

When earthquake occurs, one writes it on a letter, winds red thread around it, and makes twenty-one knots in the thread. This is hung around the neck of the nāga, and the mantra is recited twenty-one times over the crown of the nāga's head — and in that very instant a stream of rain will fall, and rain will fall exactly as the practitioner wishes.

If the rain is too heavy, one recites seven times over a blue thread, makes seven knots in it, and the heavy rain will cease to fall.

For all other rites and accomplishments of vidyās as well, this mantra is recited seven times at the very outset. It is to be applied universally. Whatever is declared, whatever accomplishment is sought, it will be achieved.

The dhāraṇī called "The Maṇḍala of the Essence of the Great Garuḍa (Skt. Garuḍa), Vajra-Blazing Power, the Essence of Garuḍa" is complete.

Following this, the rite of the root essence is now taught. The very moment the dhāraṇī is uttered, all nāgas tremble and shake. With a branch of Nepalese citron tree and a branch of the karāpīra tree, wind and clouds are to be repelled.

Because the heavy matter of the bat must not fall to the ground, one makes a very finely divided square maṇḍala with sections properly arranged on top of a building. Eight sengdeng acacia pegs of eight finger-breadths each are inserted at the eight directions and corners. Five arrows are inserted. A three-pronged implement is inserted. Around the four arrows are encircled four threads of five colors. Four filled vases, a skull-cup, and four offering-cake vases are placed. Four white offering cakes are placed in the center of the maṇḍala. Loose flowers are scattered to fill it. Barley and white mustard seeds are scattered. Over all things the mantra is recited seven times each and they are arranged. White mustard seeds mixed with water, after recitation, are used to seal off the four directions and boundaries.

Then, for the extent of a league in every direction, a great boundary will be sealed. Nāgas (Skt. nāga) that are hostile will be unable to steal anything away. Even the great nāgas will constantly be unable to bring unseasonable winds, clouds, or hail. They will be unable to harm any flowers or fruits whatsoever. Not even once will they be able to harm so much as a single blade of grass or leaf. Bound with the five bonds, all will be fettered. For eight months this boundary will remain sealed. Yakṣas (Skt. yakṣa), wandering spirits, rākṣasas, hungry ghosts (Skt. preta), kumbhāṇḍas, and vidyādhara will not pass beyond this place.

Then the knowledge-holder (vidyādhara) sits in the center of the maṇḍala and, reciting the mantra seven times over a Nepalese acacia twig, repels the nāgas. The repelling is not to be done with extreme wrathfulness. The mudrā of the nāga's cross-legged posture is to be formed: the two index fingers are raised like antennae and the two little fingers are extended. This is the mudrā of all nāgas. The moment it is displayed, harm will be done to the hearts of all nāgas. If one wishes to render the nāgas inauspicious in that direction, at that time sand will fall upon their heads. To whatever extent there is head, tail, and midsection of their body, so too will a continuous rain of sword-blows fall upon them. Then all the nāgas will remain in a state of fear and terror, and at that time they will send down streams of rain upon Jambudvīpa (Skt. jambudvīpa) at the proper seasons. All insubordinate nāgas will come under control.

A square maṇḍala is made on top of a building, filled with scattered loose flowers, fumigated with incense, and the mantra is recited seven times over all the water-filled vases. An offering cake is placed.

Reciting the mantra twenty-one times over an acacia stake, if that acacia stake is inserted in the center of the maṇḍala, winds, clouds, hail, and all harm from frost will be bound as long as the stake is not removed.

Reciting the mantra seven times over white mustard seeds, looking at the clouds, and scattering them — all hail will cease.

Reciting the mantra twenty-one times over a karavīra twig and tying it into a bracelet will cause hail to cease in all directions.

Reciting the mantra twenty-one times over red karavīra flowers and, when lightning arises, throwing them into the sky — they will remain in the sky itself, and the lightning will be bound. Reciting the mantra seven times over water and throwing it will release the binding.

When thunder sounds, recite the mantra twenty-one times over a three-pronged implement and insert it in the center of the maṇḍala — the thunder will sound and the clouds will be bound for as long as the three-pronged implement is not removed. Once it is removed, the binding is released.

Reciting the mantra seven times over a sword, holding the nāga mudrā in the cross-legged position, and gazing at the clouds — the moment it is grasped, all the nāgas will blaze and all nāgas will be struck dumb. Holding the sword and reciting the mantra one hundred and eight times, drawing a garuḍa over it with saffron, and then rotating it in whatever manner — the wings of the garuḍa will fall upon the bodies of the nāgas in exactly the same fashion. All the nāgas will be terrified and flee in the ten directions, and thereafter they will be unable to send down wind and hail.

Mixing karavīra flowers with white mustard seeds and performing a fire offering sixty times in the maṇḍala will cause all the nāgas to produce the power of cold, and one will be able to withstand hail, snow, and the like. When rain is needed, one calls down the rain at that time.

From wax, an image of a nāga four finger-breadths in size with five heads is fashioned, covered with gold, and then wrapped in a white cloth on top. The root mantra is recited one thousand times, and the image is placed inside a new, unused vase. It is wrapped in a cloth garment, and the seal is affixed.

A square maṇḍala is made from clay. Barley, rabbit dung, and white mustard seeds are scattered upon it and fumigated with incense, and the mantra is to be recited. A Nepalese citrus-wood switch is used, the mantra is recited seven

times over it, and then it is used to stir the vase gently, little by little. All hail will thereby be drawn inside the vase, and all nāgas will be brought under one's power.

An image of a nāga king is made from tallow, and the names of all the nāgas are written upon it. Whichever nāga is invoked by name and clan, that nāga will be brought under one's power and, together with its retinue, will take a seat before the holder of the vidyā mantra in the form of a brahmin and will carry out whatever is commanded.

If there is a nāga king who is unrighteous, who does not properly govern his domain, and whose nāga dwelling is the cause of crops and fruits being destroyed and wasted, one goes to that nāga's dwelling. Having bathed thoroughly and put on clean white garments, one recites the vidyā mantra twenty-one times. Elderly women will emerge from that nāga dwelling and say, "What does the holder of the vidyā mantra seek?" One does not answer them, but strikes the vajra on the ground and utters the syllable PHAṬ. The old nāga woman will weep, saying "Śī Śī," and will go back inside the dwelling. Then all the nāgas will gather, struck with terror, and will transform into the form of a young boy and sit before the holder of the vidyā mantra, saying, "Oh holder of the vidyā mantra, what do you seek?"

The holder of the vidyā mantra then recites the mantra again, and in anger strikes the Nepalese citrus-wood switch upon the ground. The one who has taken the form of a young boy will writhe on the ground and say, "Oh holder of the vidyā mantra, what do you seek?" The holder of the vidyā mantra must be without pity, and in the manner of one who subdues, subdues them, saying, "O holder of the vidyā mantra, I will do whatever you command." The holder of the vidyā mantra then speaks these words: "Uphold the pledges of the Tathāgata." The reply comes: "We will uphold them." The holder of the vidyā mantra speaks again: "Embrace the ten virtues." The reply comes: "We embrace them." The holder of the vidyā mantra then requests that they take refuge in the Three Jewels. The reply comes: "We entrust ourselves to them and will follow." The holder of the vidyā mantra requests that the stake be withdrawn. The reply comes: "We will not have it withdrawn." One then speaks as follows: "Hold fast to the pledges of the Tathāgata and only then shall the stake be withdrawn." Thereupon that nāga, together with its retinue, prostrates at one's feet. They are to be led to take refuge in the Three Jewels and to be given the path of the ten virtuous actions, and they are to be made to uphold the pledges. Then the stake is finally withdrawn, and food is offered

to them on the spot. All nāgas will thereby be brought under one's power. They will enter and dwell as if in their own home and will carry out all assigned tasks as desired, doing whatever is commanded. Wherever they are sent, they will go; all tasks they will perform. Thereafter, no nāgas hostile to that nāga dwelling will arise. In due season they will pour down streams of rain. In due season they will cause crops to ripen. There they will produce flowers, fruits, and foliage. They will not thereafter cause harm.

From the great dhāraṇī that accomplishes through recitation, all activities are to be applied. All activities will be accomplished. The supreme is accomplished. It is unsurpassed. The ritual procedures of the activity rite of the root mantra are now complete.

Then the king of garuḍas joined his palms together toward the side where the Blessed One was, bowed, and addressed the Blessed One as follows: "Blessed One, when we recite this dhāraṇī called 'The Vajra-Beak Blazing with Lightning' — which causes the hearts of all nāgas to blaze, which repels all untimely winds, clouds, and hail, which accomplishes all flowers, fruits, and crops, which increases the essence of the earth and its bounty — may the Blessed One, for the sake of completely fulfilling the hopes of all sentient beings, grant his blessing upon it."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the king of garuḍas: "Lord of garuḍas, the dhāraṇī called 'The Vajra-Beak' has been blessed. It has been blessed moreover by as many Tathāgatas, arhats, and perfectly complete buddhas as there are grains of sand in the Ganges River — eighty thousand koṭis of hundreds of thousands of them. Now, Lord of garuḍas, for the purpose of subduing nāgas that are hostile, recite it."

Then the lord of garuḍas recited this dhāraṇī called "The Vajra-Beak":

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namas caṇḍavajrapāṇaye, mahāyakṣasenāpataye.
Namas trailokyadhipataye. Namas tu tāṃ mahārājānā. Oṃ vajradante dante,
mahādante. Duti duti. Vajraśikharadante. Maṇi
kanakavicitrābharaṇavibhūṣitaśarīre. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ
phaṭ phaṭ. Nāgarājavidrāpaṇi hṛdayaṃ. Sphoṭaya vajradantena. Hūṃ hūṃ
hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Jvalita vajradantena. Hana hana. Garuḍapakṣanipatena
bhasmiṃ kuru kuru kuru kuru kuru duṣṭānāgānāṃ. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ.
Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Bho bho pannāgendra spuṭa spuṭa spuṭantu
nāgaśmāśānikrodharājā mahābala sārākrama. Jvala jvala prajvala. Hūṃ hūṃ
hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Bho garuḍarāja vajradante

suvarṇapakṣa mahābala. Mahākanakapicitrā mahūṃdara. Bhakṣaya
 duṣṭanāgaṃ pibatu bho vāyubalahakam. Hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ. Śoṣaya
 śātabalahaka garuḍa utpena. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Bho
 bho vajradanta viṭcuhuna. Vidyujjvalana. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ.
 Bhañjaya. Sarvaśaraṇimāti kramasim. Bho pannāgendramāte. Vajradantena
 mūrdhnaṃ spāṭayāmi. Hara hara. Prahara hūṃ phaṭ. Mata mata.
 Sarvanāgānāṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Tathāgatapācana manusmara hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.
 Vajrapāṇi samaya mānupālaya. Hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Trailokyādhipate arthācana
 mānupālaya. Hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Sara sara. Smara smara. Samaya mānupālaya.
 Triratna satyena. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Hrīḥ. Vajradanda sarvanāga
 vidrāvacakara hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Triratna mānupālaya hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ
 phaṭ. Pramadanta hadasa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Vinicarkahata. Hūṃ
 hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Maheśvara trisūlahastāya hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
 Garuḍatejanyastāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Garuḍavikramāya hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ
 phaṭ svāhā. Nāgakulanāśanāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Garuḍa
 sarvaśanivapanāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Sarvapāpāpāyusibhakṣaṇāya
 hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Sarvakālavātameghaśanīvarṇāya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ
 svāhā. Mahāvajrajvala svāhā. Sarvaduṣṭanāgavināśakāya svāhā.
 Karuḍaḥṛdāya svāhā. Garuḍadantāya svāhā. Sarvanāśanāya svāhā. Oṃ duru
 duru svāhā. Muru muru svāhā. Turu turu svāhā. Diri diri. Duru ru ru ru ru ru
 ru. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā.

The very moment the lord of garuḍas had recited this dhāraṇī of the
 Vajra-Beak, eighty hundred-thousands of koṭis of kings of nāgas fell face-down
 to the ground as though they had been struck a blow; sweat poured from their
 bodies, their bodies trembled violently, they fainted, and they writhed and
 rolled upon the earth. And crying out "Alas! What unbearable words of mantra
 this great dhāraṇī has spoken!" —

their bodies all trembling violently, they prostrated at the two feet of the
 Blessed One and spoke these words: "O Blessed One, protect us! O Sugata,
 protect us! Blessed One, from this day forward we shall not bring harm to
 Jambudvīpa. We shall not bring harm to flowers, fruits, or harvests. Blessed
 One, we shall regard this very region of the earth as equal to a shrine, a stūpa.
 Wherever this great king of garuḍas moves and dwells, there, O Blessed One,
 shall we continually regard it as equal to a Tathāgata's shrine. We shall
 constantly guard, protect, and shelter every village, town, province, mountain
 crag, hamlet, and temple. We shall bring about all manner of oily, sweet,
 pleasing, fragrant, moist, and richly flavored flowers, fruits, and harvests, free

from unseasonable clouds, frost, hail, and all untimely storms. We shall remove all conflict and every evil, and dispel every ill omen. At the proper seasons we shall send streams of rain. We shall cause flowers, fruits, and harvests to come to full and perfect fruition. We shall remove and utterly dispel every danger from horseflies, mosquitoes, long-mouthed gnats, rats, snakes, frogs, traima-bukas, mākṣikas, trailatas, centipedes, bees, worms, and mountain leeches. We shall fully pacify and turn back every epidemic disease and pestilence. Blessed One, from this day forward we shall not go about in the manner of those who engage in all sinful deeds. We shall ensure that harmful rain does not fall, and that all untimely rains shall not arise. Blessed One, we shall abide by our own sworn vow. Blessed One, we shall fully uphold the vow of the training that accords with the intention of the Three Jewels. Blessed One, from this day forward we shall not harm the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa; we shall protect them fully as though each were our only child. Blessed One, in accordance with the word of the Tathāgata, in the future, in times to come, we shall fully protect all sentient beings, hold them in our embrace, and bring about every virtue, happiness, and good harvest."

Then the Blessed One comforted the kings of the nāgas and declared: "O kings of the nāgas, act in exactly this way. Do not abandon it."

Then, following upon that, the rite to be performed is to be spoken:

This mantra, unique in its heroic power,
performs every deed and is wholly virtuous.
Let a person of wisdom recall it just once
and every aim shall be accomplished thereby.

In a high place, one who is learned
should proclaim it with a great and resonant cry.
In every location where that sound is proclaimed,
no unseasonable winds, frost, clouds, hail, or lightning shall prevail.
No one shall be able to steal the bounty of those places.
No harm shall befall them.

Having purified oneself as a vidyādhāra on a high hill, in a forest retreat, a village, a temple, or a very tall building, one dons clean white garments and faces east. One prepares a square maṇḍala one cubit across, mixed from white clay and mud. In the center of the maṇḍala one plants an arrow, and recites the mantra twenty-one times. At the four corners of the maṇḍala one inserts acacia pegs eight finger-widths long, and recites the mantra

twenty-one times. One then encircles the whole with a five-colored thread wound three times around. In the center of the maṇḍala one places an incense burner and fumigates with incense over which the mantra has been recited seven times.

One recites the mantra twenty-one times, then scatters white mustard seed. One scatters a profusion of flower petals. At the four cardinal directions one places four torma vessels. In the center of the maṇḍala one sets out a torma offering, topping it with yogurt, milk, cooked rice, raw sugar, and refined sugar. Over water and white mustard seed one recites the mantra five times, and then one seals off the four directions. This is to be performed when the moon is in the fish constellation (Pisces). One reads aloud in a loud voice, scatters white mustard seed to the four directions, above, and below, and calls out each of the nāgas by name one by one. As soon as this rite is performed, all unseasonable winds, clouds, and hail, and all nāgas that are hostile, will be bound and subdued. All ill omens, epidemic diseases, harms, contagious illnesses, spirit possessions, flesh-eating demons, yakṣas, and all rākṣasas will be driven far away. A great boundary will be sealed for a full league in every direction all around. All sicknesses and the sick, those who intend harm and those who intend severe harm, all enemies and all who would do injury, will be rendered powerless. All flowers, fruits, and crops will come to full and perfect completion, will ripen excellently, and will be of fine flavor. All properly sown seeds will sprout well. All acts of slaughter, harmful workings, and magical attacks will be utterly destroyed and rendered powerless. For as long as the stake has not been pulled out, a great boundary will remain sealed. For that entire time all nāgas will send down a continuous stream of rain. All flowers, fruits, and crops will come to full and perfect abundance.

Whatever one may need, wherever one may need it, if one merely calls it to mind once, it will be accomplished.

From red sandalwood paste one fashions an image of Garuḍa eight finger-widths in size, seated in cross-legged posture, with wings spread, with the Nāga King beneath as his seat, holding nine nāga heads as his crown ornament, holding three nāga heads in his right hand, and holding a blazing precious jewel in his left hand, covered in gold. One draws the image in colors in the proper ritual manner and places it on a variety of seats. Over the course of one day one recites the mantra one thousand times. When one is unable to perform the full ritual with a naked body, one eats white food, bathes again, and then performs the accomplishment practice. One fumigates with bdellium

resin. One uses whatever flowers, incense, and torma offerings are available. If one lights a lamp and sleeps before the image, it will reveal things and will declare all deeds. It will bestow all excellent things and accomplish all activities. It will carry out whatever one commands.

One then places the image in a location free from disturbance. When the right time has come, a mantrin takes it up and conveys it with reverence to a nāga abode. One places it at a lake that is a nāga abode, offers flowers and incense, recites the mantra over white mustard seed three times, and scatters it at that place. Immediately all nāgas will send down a continuous stream of rain. If rain does not stream down immediately, then all the nāga abodes will be seen to be filled with Garuḍas, the abode will blaze with a single tongue of fire, sand will fall upon the nāgas' heads, and the water will dry up. When the right moment has come, if one displays the image to a cloud, rain will fall. If one displays it to wind, clouds, hail, frost, and rain clouds, they will vanish in an instant. Within a range of seven leagues in all four directions, hail will not fall, and frost and unseasonable winds will be rendered powerless; all will be subdued.

When a storm wind is raging, one places the image at a crossroads on the road, or alternatively at the gate of a town, or at the gate of a royal palace.

All winds will be cut off. Even when a great wind is scattered and raging, it will be cut off and will be unable to rise again. The moment the image is displayed, all nāgas will flee.

All the rites performed through the dhāraṇī of the Vajra-Flaming Tongue — that is, those performed through reciting the Garuḍa — will accomplish the supreme of accomplishments.

Then Brahmā, the Great God (Śiva), the great kings, and the Blessed One all went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they circumambulated the Blessed One three times. They then addressed the Blessed One in these words:

"Blessed One, all of us gathered here wish to recite the dhāraṇī known as 'The Mouth from Which Falls the Vajra-Flaming Tongue' — she who tears out the hearts of all nāgas, who crushes their hearts, who destroys the lineage of nāgas that refuse to submit, who dispels all winds, clouds, and hail, and who produces all crops, flowers, and fruits. We offer this so that it may serve as medicine for all sentient beings. May the Blessed One bestow his blessing upon it."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Great God, and the four great kings:

"Sons of noble lineage, recite it now, for I have blessed it for the benefit, welfare, and happiness of all sentient beings."

Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Great God, and the four great kings recited this dhāraṇī:

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namō bhagavate Śākyamunaye tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Namaś caṇḍavajradhārāya mahābalaparākramāya. Namas trailokyamūrtaye. Namaś caturmahārājānām. Namō vajrāśani jvalitaraudraḍḍahasāya. Jaya mahābalavīryaparākrama krodhārāja prahme su-brahme brahmasvara bho bho nāga adhipati bisara bisara. Mare brahmadante nāmurdhanām. Brataya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Bhara bhara. Bikṣu cakra hasta na viṣṇā gendu mati biṣṭa cakre śrī chindāmi. Tuti tuti. Lili lili. Hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Muhu muhu huyanaṭu sarva puṣṭa nāgaṃ. Sphoṭaya hṛdayaṃ maheśvara jvalita triśūladhara. Hana hana hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Muci mucī. Tuti tuti. Bhava bhava. Kṣiṇi kṣiṇi kṣiṇi. Catūrṇām marīcīnaṃ jvalita śaktidhara dhāra. Hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Sphura sphura. Bisphura bisphura. Cara cara. Nāśaya duṣṭaṃ nāga hṛdayaṃ. Sphoṭaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Saṃhara saṃhara duṣṭaṃ yaśani vatī nāga nāśita vidyujjvalabhasmi kuru hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā. Samaya manusmarabho nāgayādhipate vajrīvaya bho bho tuti tuti hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā. Vajra aśani nāśaya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Sarva nāga hṛdayāni visphoṭaya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Buddhavilokitāya svāhā. Brahmāya svāhā. Viṣṇumūrti svāhā. Maheśvara jvalita triśūlāya svāhā. Caturmahārāja samaya dhārāya svāhā. Bhujagāya svāhā. Nāgādhipataye svāhā. Oṃ dhiri dhiri svāhā. Jvalitavaktrāya svāhā. Romahāra nāśaya svāhā. Juṭi juṭi juṭi svāhā. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā.

The instant this dhāraṇī known as "The Mouth from Which Falls the Vajra-Flaming Tongue" was recited, all the insubordinate nāgas found their bodies rotting and giving off a foul stench; their bodies became parched and crumbling, and their flesh broke out in lesions. They then touched the two feet of the Blessed One and spoke these words:

"Blessed One, please protect us! Blessed One, we have become objects of scorn in the world together with its gods."

"Blessed One, we are destroyed. Blessed One, from this time forward we will do no harm and no injury to the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa."

At the recitation of this dhāraṇī, "The Mouth from Which Falls the Vajra-Flaming Tongue," all the nāgas harbor ill will and do not come — they will not so much as look, let alone approach. What need is there to say more? Then, when its ritual is recited, by the mere recollection of this dhāraṇī, the bodies of all the nāgas are shattered into pieces, and their bodies become foul-smelling. When the mantra is recited twenty-one times over white mustard seeds and scattered in the four directions, all the nāgas are bound, and a boundary is sealed in a ring seven leagues around. When the mantra is recited one hundred and eight times over a vajra, the nāgas are repelled. Reciting it just once repels all wind, clouds, and hail — they are all made to vanish. By mere recollection alone, all hail disappears in an instant. Even if it does fall, in a moment it turns to water. When hail is falling, if a vajra is waved in a circle, in whichever direction it is waved the hail is driven away, and hail will not fall in that direction.

In the early morning, go to a solitary place, enter within, settle into meditative equipoise, bind the mudrā (Skt. mudrā) of the cross-legged posture, recite the mantra thirty-two times, and the moment of recitation all wind, clouds, and hail are made to vanish; all winds are utterly dispersed and will no longer arise. If white mustard seeds are scattered in the four directions, a boundary is sealed in a ring for one year; all wind, clouds, and hail are bound. All the nāgas come under one's power. Their sons and grandsons together with their retinues will follow in an unbroken, continuous stream, and will perform every task. When the mantra is recited twenty-one times over a bell and it is rung at the time hail is falling, the heads of all insubordinate nāgas will split open, and they will fall from the sky to the ground. All tasks will be accomplished. This dhāraṇī will be unimpeded everywhere.

Then the Blessed One gave the word "Excellent!" to Garuḍa (the great lord of the sky-soaring ones), to Brahmā, to Viṣṇu, and to the Great God (Śiva). He said: "Great Brahmā, it is excellent, excellent, that for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings — to tame, to eliminate, and to cut down with punishment the insubordinate nāgas who have no compassion and who do harm — you have recited the words of this great vidyā dhāraṇī mantra and established it in Jambudvīpa."

Then the great nāga king Ocean, the great nāga king Completely Encircling, and yet another great nāga king of great majesty and great miraculous power, along with many tens of millions of other insubordinate nāgas, all went to where the Blessed One was, arrived, and prostrated with their heads at the

"Blessed One, we, together with our retinues, in the future, in the time to come, will protect the flowers, fruits, crops, leaves, and branches of all of Jambudvīpa, and will nurture them fully. We will repel all wind, clouds, hail, frost, and blight. We will send down timely streams of rain. By our own sworn oath, we wish to uphold the pledge of the Tathāgata. We wish to bring to full completion the hopes of all sentient beings and to fulfill their aims. We wish to do no harm. Blessed One, if beyond this sovereign king of ritual there is a mantra higher than this —"

Tadyathā: pa ki tsa ti, śu li śu mu li, śa śa śu śu, ti ti bi ri ti, hu yu hu yu, hu ri ti svāhā.

The Blessed One declared: "O king of nāgas, do as I have said."

Translator's Notes

- The phrase "འགྲོ་བཤུན་རྒྱལ་པོ་།" and "འགྲོ་བཤུན་རྒྱལ་པོ་དང་།" refers to nāga-king Jokpo as the first of the nāga retinue; Jokpo is the Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit nāga name not immediately recoverable from this passage alone.

The phrase "雨雹石雨" literally means "rain falling in tongues" or "hailstone rain" — the passage seems to describe the nāga sending hail earlier (雨雹石雨) and here sending a downpour; the nāga's action is punitive and hostile, so "great torrent of hailstone rain" captures the ambiguity, though it may simply mean a torrential downpour used as a weapon.

- The mantra passage is transliterated directly from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit mantric syllables. Many syllables are obscure or corrupt in the Tibetan transmission and do not yield fully transparent Sanskrit; they are rendered as faithfully as the Tibetan spelling allows without emendation. The phrase rendered "struck on the head" for སྤྱུང་བའི་རྒྱུ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ (literally "came to be at/in the head") describes a painful physical affliction caused by the vidyā's power, consistent with the narrative convention of subjugating nāgas. The line སྤྱུང་བའི་རྒྱུ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ ("the sword of loving-kindness") is a striking image and is rendered literally as the text has it; it refers to the protective, cutting quality of the loving-kindness the nāgas vow to embody.
- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the supplied Tibetan text; the translation ends accordingly. The phrase rendered "shallow bowls" translates a term literally meaning "individual flat bowls," referring to small offering vessels. The five products of the cow is a standard ritual set: milk, yoghurt, butter, urine, and dung. The creatures listed in the pest-removal section include some whose precise identification is uncertain — "sha sbrang" may refer to mosquitoes or horseflies, and "nau le" to a mongoose or similar animal; both are rendered by their most probable referents in context.
- The names Nyewar Dor (Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit name, likely Niśvāsadara or similar), traimabuka, trailata, viśakitaka, picilika, lomika, kantika, māluśika, śaṅganika, madurika, khanajana, and khugarta are transliterated Sanskrit terms appearing in Tibetan phonetic rendering. Their precise Sanskrit originals and exact identifications as creatures are not always recoverable with certainty; the renderings here follow the phonetics as closely as possible. The creature name "rikegs" is similarly a phonetic Tibetan form of an unidentified Sanskrit term.
- The great sage who speaks the vidyā and performs the ritual is identified in the preceding passage as Nyesador, a Tibetan rendering of Durvāsas, the famously wrathful sage of Indian tradition. The name does not appear in this segment but consistency with the prior rendering is maintained.

The phrase rendered "with the silent recitation of the sage" translates "drang strong gi mi smra bas," literally "by the sage's not-speaking" or "by the sage's silence," referring to the convention of scattering the charged seeds without uttering a sound aloud — a recognised tantric ritual procedure.

- The term rendered "child-devouring crocodiles" (སྤྱུང་བའི་རྒྱུ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་) literally means "crocodiles that kill children" and is a stock descriptor for a type of fearsome aquatic creature; it is retained literally as the text uses it descriptively rather than as a species name. The creature སྤྱུང་བའི་རྒྱུ་ལྷོ་ལྷོ་ could also be rendered "water-turtle" or "large fish" in some traditions; "makara-fish" is offered here as a conventional rendering for an unspecified large aquatic creature, though the precise species is indeterminate. The ūṛṇā (ལྷོ་ལྷོ་) is the tuft or curl of hair between the eyebrows, one of the thirty-two major marks of a great being.
- The four great kings are here named in Tibetan as Rnam thos kyi bu (Vaiśravaṇa), Yul 'khor srung (Dhṛtarāṣṭra), 'Phags skyes po (Virūḍhaka), and Mig mi bzang (Virūpākṣa). Their directional roles are supplied from standard Buddhist cosmology for listener clarity, as the text does not specify them here.

The mantra transliteration follows the Tibetan phonetic rendering as closely as possible. The Sanskrit underlying several syllables is not fully recoverable from the Tibetan orthography alone, and some syllables may represent corrupted or variant forms of the Sanskrit original. The rendering here is a best reconstruction and should be treated as approximate.

- The passage contains a nāga oath-mantra rendered phonetically in the Tibetan. The phrase "seeds of rebirth one hundred and eight cast upon the nāga seeds as hailstones" renders a somewhat obscure ritual prescription; the Tibetan skye tshe'i sa bon brya rtsa bryad klu'i sa bon du mtshe'u dor ro, which literally means "one hundred and eight seeds of [future] lives

shall be cast as hailstones onto the nāga seeds." This appears to be a ritual act of cursing or coercion involving hail-seed substances, the precise technical details of which are not fully transparent from the text alone.

- The nāga king names rendered here follow the Tibetan phonetically where no standard Sanskrit equivalent is established: "Ocean" for ལྷ་མཚོ།, "Canopy" for རྒྱུ་མཚོ།, "Water God" for ལྷ་མཚོ།, and "Lambukāra" for ལའུ་མཚོ།. The last is a direct transliteration of what appears to be a Sanskrit name; the others are semantic renderings of Tibetan epithets.

The plant name ལྷ་མཚོ། is uncertain; it may be a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit plant name not yet identified with certainty. It is rendered here as "surāviṇacana" in transliteration.

The term ལྷ་མཚོ། in the fourth ritual, literally "one possessing wisdom," likely refers to a qualified mantra-holder or ritual specialist, and is rendered accordingly.

- The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering; standard Sanskrit reconstruction of some syllables, particularly "bhuḍze," is uncertain, and scholars differ on the underlying Sanskrit. The rendering here follows the Tibetan phonetics consistently.

The term rendered "Nepalese peach tree" (bal po se'u shing) refers to a tree identified in Tibetan medical and ritual literature with a variety of peach or similar fruit tree associated with Nepal; the precise botanical identification remains a matter of some discussion in the secondary literature.

- The great king with golden-winged eyes and a vajra beak is Garuḍa, the mythic lord of birds and traditional enemy of nāgas, here left unnamed in the Tibetan but clearly identified by these standard iconographic features. The Tibetan nam mkha'i lding gi dbang po is literally "lord of the sky-soaring ones," a standard epithet for Garuḍa.

The phrase translated as "mottled patches will appear on our bodies" renders sha bkra 'byung bar 'gyur, literally "variegated flesh will arise," understood as a sign of physical deterioration or disease appearing on the nāgas' bodies as a consequence of breaking their oath; this is the punishment for failing to produce rain as pledged.

- The mantra and dhāraṇī passages throughout this section are transliterated Sanskrit rendered phonetically in Tibetan script. The transliteration is sometimes irregular or corrupted in transmission, as is typical for dhāraṇī texts. The transcription given here follows the Tibetan phonetics as closely as possible while suggesting recognizable Sanskrit forms where they are recoverable; some syllables remain opaque and may represent textual corruption or non-standard Indic forms. Listeners should understand these as sacred mantra syllables to be received as transmitted, not as parsed Sanskrit prose.

The phrase rendered "enough" in the nāga kings' plea follows the Tibetan "ཡིད་མཚོ།" and "ཡིད་མཚོ།," which are respectful formulaic expressions of supplication meaning something like "that is enough" or "let it be so" — a plea for the torment to cease.

- The nāga king names in the final section are transliterated from Tibetan approximations of Sanskrit or possibly non-Sanskrit originals. The renderings given follow reasonable phonological reconstruction: ལྷ་མཚོ། is interpretively rendered as "surrounded on all sides in the form of a canopy," treating it as a descriptive phrase qualifying the Nāga King rather than a named king; this is contextually and grammatically the most natural reading. The phrase ལྷ་མཚོ། is a compound proper name rendered as "Crest of the All-Blazing and Supremely Joyous Opener." The passage ends in mid-sentence, as does the source text, anticipating continuation.

- The phrase rendered "Eye That Sees All" and "Viṣṇu's Encirclement" involve slightly

interpretive readings: the former translates རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ literally, and the latter renders རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ where རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་ is the standard Tibetan rendering of Viṣṇu. The name "Blazing Splendor of Garuḍa" renders རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་, where རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་ is the standard Tibetan for Garuḍa, the divine eagle regarded as lord and enemy of nāgas in the Indo-Tibetan tradition. The final sentence "will be subdued and bound" renders རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ as two parallel results of the ritual action, both concerning the meteorological phenomena listed.

- The phrase rendered "wool or silk cord" translates a Tibetan term that may refer specifically to a cord made from wool fiber; the reading is slightly ambiguous but the general sense is a twisted or braided ritual cord.

The term "sengdeng acacia" renders the Tibetan sengdeng, a thorny acacia tree commonly used in Tibetan ritual contexts for its protective properties; the Sanskrit equivalent is *Acacia catechu* or a related species.

"Nāga flower" renders the Sanskrit loanword *nāgapuṣpa* preserved in Tibetan transliteration; the botanical identification is uncertain but it is a standard ritual ingredient in *nāga*-pacification rites.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, indicating the translation breaks off at the point where the list of ingredients is incomplete.

- The phrase rendered "the grain of life-seeds" translates *skye tshe'i 'bru*, a somewhat unusual compound; it likely refers to grains used in life-extending or vitality rituals associated with *nāga* propitiation, rather than a single identifiable ingredient. The interpretation is contextually reasonable but the precise referent is uncertain.

The phrase rendered "heavy matter of the bat" translates ba'i lcib ba (literally "the heavy/thick matter of bats"), which is obscure. It may refer to bat guano used as a ritual substance that must not touch the ground, or it may indicate something else entirely. This is a genuinely uncertain reading.

- The term rendered here as "karavīra" (Tibetan: ཀ་ར་བེ་ར་) is a transliteration of Sanskrit karavīra, the oleander plant (*Nerium oleander*), commonly used in ritual contexts. The identification is standard.

The phrase rendered "vidyādhara" (Tibetan: བཤེན་པོ་) is literally "secret ones" or "those who hold secrets," which is somewhat unusual; in lists of supernatural beings it can refer to vidyādhara or to a class of spirit. The translation follows the most contextually fitting reading.

- The term rendered "Nepalese citrus-wood switch" is a standard interpretive rendering; the plant in question (bal po se'u shing) is identified in Tibetan pharmacological tradition as a species of citrus or related rutaceous plant brought from Nepal, used in nāga-ritual contexts. The precise botanical identity is debated in the scholarly literature but this rendering follows the most widely accepted traditional interpretation.

The phrase "śī śī" is onomatopoeic in the Tibetan, representing the sound of weeping or a hissing sound; it is left in transliteration as it is a direct phonetic rendering of the nāga woman's cry rather than a translatable expression.

- The mantra syllables have been rendered in standard Sanskrit transliteration, following the source phonetics as closely as the Tibetan phonetic transcription allows. Some syllables are imperfectly recoverable from the Tibetan phonetic rendering, and minor variations from a hypothetical Sanskrit original should be expected. The phrase "eighty hundred-thousands of koṭis" renders a large numerical compound in the Tibetan: bye ba khrag khrig brgya stong phrag brgyad cu, a stacked number meaning eighty times a hundred thousand times a koṭi (ten million). The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of this passage, indicating a continuation

follows.

- The series of Indic creature names — *ṭraimabuka*, *mākṣika*, *trailata*, *śatapada* — are preserved as transliterated Sanskrit since the Tibetan is itself a transliteration of obscure Indic terms for insects, pests, or vermin; their precise identification is uncertain but *mākṣika* is "fly" and *śatapada* is "centipede."

The phrase rendered "one who is learned" translating mkhas pa could also mean "a skilled ritualist"; the context of a rite makes either reading appropriate, but "learned" is retained for its broader resonance.

- The term rendered "fish constellation" for 𐎧𐎺𐎠 is the lunar mansion or zodiacal sign associated with Pisces; the precise astronomical reference may vary by calendar system, but "moon in the fish constellation" conveys the intended auspicious timing.

The figure □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could mean either "with the Nāga King placed as his seat" or "with a nāga king cast down as his throne," both being standard iconographic descriptions of Garuḍa. The translation follows the standard iconographic convention.

- The dhāraṇī passage is transliterated from Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit and is not fully recoverable to standard Sanskrit in every syllable; the transliteration here follows the Tibetan as closely as possible while applying standard Sanskrit orthography where the syllables are recognizable. Several syllable clusters appear corrupt or compressed in transmission and cannot be confidently restored to a Sanskrit original without a parallel Sanskrit manuscript.

The term rendered "the great kings" throughout refers to the four great kings (caturmahārāja), the divine guardians of the four directions, though in the narrative frame they are sometimes listed alongside Brahmā and Śiva as a collective group rather than as a strict enumeration of four individuals.

- The phrase rendered "Garuḍa, the great lord of the sky-soaring ones" translates the Tibetan epithet meaning literally "great lord of the sky-flyers," which is the standard Tibetan rendering of Garuḍa's title; the identification with Garuḍa is secure from context and the Indian tradition. "Completely Encircling" is a translation of the nāga king's name Rnam par kun nas bskor ba, rendered literally as the Tibetan gives it. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, which is preserved faithfully as the passage simply continues beyond this excerpt.
- The phrase translated as "the one who holds the mantra" renders rig pa 'dzin pa, literally "vidyādhara" — a holder or bearer of the knowledge mantra. The instruction is addressed to this practitioner rather than to the nāgas themselves.

The concluding line is a colophon formula marking the end of the text; "Vajramukha" is the name of the ritual cycle (the title given at the close).

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.